

The Contemporary World

SOCSCI 3 — Complete Study Reference · Aligned to the Official OBTL Plan

Course: **SOCSCI 3**

Units: **3 units**

CHED Mandate: **GE Core Course**

Structure: **18 weeks, syllabus-mapped**

CHAPTER 00

Course Overview

The Contemporary World is one of the CHED-mandated General Education courses required across ALL Philippine college programs, regardless of major. It examines **globalization** — the accelerating interconnection of the world's economies, governments, cultures, and peoples — and asks what that interconnection means for ordinary people, nations, and the Philippines specifically. This edition of the guide has been restructured chapter-by-chapter to follow the official Week 1–18 Outcomes-Based Teaching and Learning (OBTL) Plan issued for this course, so each chapter lines up with what's actually being covered in class that week, rather than a general independent reference order.

Why "Contemporary" Actually Matters Here

This is not a history course. When your professor asks about "the current state of globalization," they want you to reference genuinely recent developments — trade tensions, shifting alliances, new technology — not decade-old textbook examples. This guide includes several 2025–2026 developments specifically because currency is part of the actual subject matter.

Week-by-Week Topic & Chapter Map

Week	Official OBTL Topic	Guide Chapter	Graded Output
1-2	Introduction to Globalization; Metaphors of Globalization	01	Quiz, Recitation, "A Picture Says A Thousand Words"
3-4	Structure of Globalization; History of the Global Economy; 4th Industrial Revolution	02	Quiz, Recitation, "Global Nostradamus" activity
5-6	Facilitators of Globalization; Theories of Globalization	03	Recitation, Worksheet, Quiz
7-8	Global Interstate System; Global Governance	04	Recitation, Worksheet
9	MIDTERM EXAMINATION		
10-11	North-South Divide; Global Inequality; Latin America; ASEAN	05	Recitation, Quiz
12-13	Media Platforms and Globalization	06	Recitation, Worksheet
14-15	Global Population & Mobility; Demographic Transition; Migration; Urbanization	07	Recitation, Quiz, "My Kind of City" activity
16-17	Globalization Amid the Deadly Pandemic (COVID-19)	08	Recitation, Reflection Paper, Quiz

Week	Official OBTL Topic	Guide Chapter	Graded Output
18	FINAL EXAMINATION		

Grading Breakdown (per official syllabus)

Class Standing is 60% of each term grade, broken down as: Active Participation 15%, Quizzes 15%, Project 20%, Assignment 10%. The remaining 40% is the Midterm/Final Exam itself. Your overall Final Grade is the average of your Midterm Grade and Final Term Grade (50/50). Since Class Standing carries more weight than either single exam, consistent recitation and quiz performance across every week matters more than cramming before the two big exams.

Exam & Discussion Priority Map

Topic	Chapter	Weight	Format Usually Tested
Globalization definitions, dimensions & metaphors	01	Very High	Identification, essay, visual/metaphor activity
Global economy, 4IR & economic history	02	High	Identification, case analysis
Facilitators & theories of globalization	03	High	Identification, position paper, essay
Interstate system & global governance (UN system)	04	High	Identification, structure diagrams
North-South divide, inequality, Latin America, ASEAN	05	Medium-High	Identification, regional case study
Media & cultural globalization	06	Medium	Reflection essay, examples
Population, migration,	07	Medium-High	

Topic	Chapter	Weight	Format Usually Tested
demographic transition, OFWs			Case study, Philippine-specific essay
COVID-19 & globalization	08	High (final-term)	Reflection paper, quiz
Environment, SDGs & global citizenship	09	Not on official OBTL – enrichment only	May surface in a comprehensive final essay

One Thing to Verify With Your Professor

Chapter 09 (environment/SDGs/global citizenship) does NOT appear anywhere in the official Week 1–18 topic list you were given — it's kept in this guide purely as general GE enrichment since it's a common theme in other sections of this course. Don't over-invest study time there unless your professor explicitly mentions it in class or announces additional modules.

WEEK 1–2

CHAPTER 01

Understanding Globalization & Its Metaphors

Before analyzing globalization's effects, you need a precise working definition, a map of its dimensions, and — per your syllabus — familiarity with the well-known "metaphors" scholars and journalists use to explain it in vivid, memorable terms. This chapter directly supports the "A Picture Says A Thousand Words" group activity, since each metaphor below is essentially a compact visual image for a bigger idea.

| Working Definition

Globalization is the ongoing process by which economies, societies, cultures, and populations become increasingly interconnected and interdependent through the accelerated flow of trade, capital, people, information, and ideas across national borders. It is NOT a single event with a start date — it is an intensifying, uneven, and contested PROCESS, still actively unfolding and even reversing in some areas today.



| The Five Dimensions of Globalization

Economic

Global trade, finance, multinational corporations, supply chains

Political

International organizations, treaties, shared governance, sovereignty tension

Cultural

Shared media, values, lifestyles spreading across borders

Technological

Internet, mobile networks, AI — the infrastructure enabling all other dimensions

Ecological

Climate change, pollution, and resource use as borderless, shared problems

Filipino Example Touching All Five Dimensions

A single Filipino nurse working in the UK sending money home via GCash touches all five at once: **economic** (remittance flow), **political** (bilateral labor agreements between PH and UK), **cultural** (Filipino traditions carried abroad, British culture absorbed), **technological** (instant digital money transfer), and **ecological** (the carbon footprint of international travel itself). This is the kind of multi-dimensional example professors want you to construct on essay exams.

Three Major Theoretical Perspectives on Globalization

Scholars disagree sharply on how significant, new, and beneficial globalization actually is. Three broad camps dominate the academic debate — expect exam questions asking you to identify or apply one of these.

Perspective	Core Claim	Key Idea
Hyperglobalist	Globalization is real, new, and transformative — the nation-state is becoming less relevant as global markets and institutions take over	Borders are dissolving; we live in a genuinely "borderless world" economically
Skeptic	Globalization is exaggerated — international trade levels today aren't fundamentally different from earlier historical peaks (e.g. pre-WWI trade), and nation-states remain the dominant actors	What we call "globalization" is mostly regionalization between blocs (EU, ASEAN, NAFTA/USMCA), not true global integration
Transformationalist	Globalization is real and significant, but its outcomes are unpredictable, uneven,	The most widely accepted "middle ground" view among contemporary scholars — globalization changes HOW

Perspective

Core Claim

Key Idea

and actively reshape (not eliminate) state power

states govern, not WHETHER they govern

Exam-Critical Fact — 2026 Events Actually Support the Skeptic View

The United States formally withdrawing from over 60 international organizations in January 2026 and rejecting the UN's Sustainable Development Goals is a textbook example Skeptics would point to: even the world's most powerful economy can simply choose to disengage from global institutions when it suits national interest — evidence that state sovereignty, not borderless global governance, still drives outcomes. This is a genuinely current, citable example for essay questions on this theory.

Key Theorists to Know

Thomas Friedman

Journalist, b. 1953

"The World Is Flat" (2005)

Popularized the hyperglobalist idea that technology has "flattened" competitive playing fields globally, allowing individuals and small firms anywhere to compete internationally.

Arjun Appadurai

Anthropologist, b. 1949

Five Global "Scapes"

Proposed globalization flows through 5 dimensions: ethnoscap (people), mediascapes (images/info), technoscapes (technology), finanscapes (capital), and ideoscapes (ideologies).

Roland Robertson

Sociologist, b. 1938

Coined "Glocalization"

Argued global and local forces don't simply replace each other — they blend, producing hybrid outcomes adapted to local contexts. Central to Chapter 06.

The Metaphors of Globalization

Because "globalization" is such an abstract, sprawling process, several influential writers built their entire arguments around a single vivid metaphor or image — partly to make the concept memorable, partly to push a specific interpretation of what globalization IS. These are the metaphors most commonly compiled in Philippine "Contemporary World" reviewers and modules; each one doubles as a visual you could sketch for the "A Picture Says A Thousand Words" activity.

Metaphor / Work	Author	Core Idea
The Lexus and the Olive Tree	Thomas Friedman	Globalization pits the drive for modern prosperity and technology (the Lexus car) against the pull of tradition, identity, and community (the olive tree) — nations must find balance between the two, not choose only one.
The World Is Flat	Thomas Friedman	Digital technology has "flattened" the global economic playing field, letting individuals, small firms, and developing economies compete directly against large, established ones.
Jihad vs. McWorld	Benjamin Barber	Globalization provokes two opposite reactions at once: a homogenizing, corporate consumer culture ("McWorld") on one side, and a defensive retreat into tribal, ethnic, or religious identity ("Jihad") on the other.
The Clash of Civilizations	Samuel Huntington	Post-Cold War global conflict is driven less by ideology or economics and more by cultural and religious fault lines between major civilizational blocs (Western, Islamic, Sinic, etc.).
The End of History	Francis Fukuyama	With the Cold War's end, liberal democracy and free-market capitalism represent the final, most evolved form of political-economic organization, toward which all societies are gradually converging.
McDonaldization	George Ritzer	The organizing principles of the fast-food industry —

Metaphor / Work

Author

Core Idea

efficiency, calculability, predictability, and control — increasingly shape institutions worldwide far beyond food, standardizing global life.

Verify Against Your Own Module/PPT

These six are the most widely circulated set in Philippine GE reviewers for this exact topic, but the precise roster your professor emphasizes can vary slightly depending on which module or textbook chapter was assigned. When you receive the actual PPT or module for this week, cross-check the list — the underlying idea (each metaphor = one author's central argument about globalization) will still hold either way.

How These Connect Back to the Three Perspectives

Notice the metaphors aren't neutral — each leans toward one of the three theoretical camps above. Friedman's two books ("Lexus," "Flat") are essentially hyperglobalist arguments dressed up as travel narratives. Barber's "Jihad vs. McWorld" and Huntington's "Clash of Civilizations" are more skeptical of a smooth, unified global future. Being able to say WHICH camp a given metaphor supports, and why, is a strong move on an identification or short-essay item.

WEEK 3–4

CHAPTER 02

Structure of Globalization, the Modern Global Economy & the Fourth Industrial Revolution

This chapter covers three linked ideas from your syllabus: HOW globalization is structured as a system, the specific HISTORY of how today's global

economy was built, and the technological wave — the Fourth Industrial Revolution — currently reshaping that economy in real time.

| The "Structures" of Globalization

Where Chapter 01 introduced globalization's five DIMENSIONS as a way of describing what kind of activity is happening, thinking in terms of **structures** asks a slightly different question: what are the actual systems and institutions that carry each dimension out? Most Contemporary World modules organize the rest of the course around exactly these structures — which is also, not coincidentally, how this guide's remaining chapters are organized.

Structure	Carries Out	Covered In
Economic structure	Trade, finance, MNCs, supply chains, trade blocs	This chapter + Ch. 03, 05
Political structure	The interstate system, treaties, intergovernmental organizations	Chapter 04
Cultural structure	Media, entertainment, consumer values, language	Chapter 06
Demographic structure	Population movement, migration, urbanization	Chapter 07
Ecological/technological structure	Shared environmental systems and the tech infrastructure enabling every other structure	This chapter (4IR) + Chapter 09

| History of the Modern Global Economy

Today's global economic system wasn't inevitable — it was deliberately built, mostly after two catastrophic collapses in global cooperation.

1914–1945

The Great Reversal

Two World Wars and the Great Depression caused a dramatic RETREAT from global trade and integration — proof that globalization is not automatically permanent or one-directional. Countries turned inward (protectionism, tariffs) during this period.

1944–1947

Post-War Institution Building

The Bretton Woods Conference (1944) created the IMF and World Bank. The GATT (General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade, precursor to the WTO) was signed in 1947 — deliberately designed to prevent a repeat of the 1930s trade collapse.

1989–1991

Post-Cold War Acceleration

Fall of the Berlin Wall (1989) and Soviet collapse (1991) opened former communist economies to global markets — widely seen as the start of the most intense phase of globalization to date.

1995

World Trade Organization Founded

Replaced GATT with a permanent, more powerful institution to govern global trade rules and resolve disputes between nations.

2001–2010s

The Digital & Internet Wave

China joins the WTO (2001), smartphones and broadband internet spread globally, social media connects billions instantly — capital and information now move at near-zero marginal cost across borders.

2025–2026

Rising Deglobalization Pressures

Renewed tariff disputes, the US withdrawing from dozens of international bodies, and a new 1% US tax on cross-border remittances (including OFW money transfers) signal a possible partial retreat from deep global integration — actively debated as this guide is being written.

The Big Three Post-War Institutions

IMF

World Bank

WTO

Founded 1944, Bretton Woods

International Monetary Fund

Monitors global financial stability, provides emergency loans to countries facing balance-of-payments crises, usually attached to policy conditions ("structural adjustment") the borrowing country must follow.

Founded 1944, Bretton Woods

International Bank for Reconstruction & Development

Provides long-term loans and grants for development projects (infrastructure, education, health) in developing countries, distinct from the IMF's short-term crisis focus.

Founded 1995, Geneva

World Trade Organization

Sets global trade rules, negotiates trade agreements between member states, and provides a formal system for resolving trade disputes between countries.

Common Point of Confusion — IMF vs World Bank

Students frequently mix these up. Simple distinction: the **IMF** is like an emergency room — short-term crisis loans to stabilize a country's finances. The **World Bank** is like a long-term investor — development loans for building things (roads, schools, power grids) over years or decades.

Multinational Corporations, Supply Chains & Trade Policy

Multinational corporations (MNCs) operate production, sales, or services across multiple countries simultaneously — among the most powerful economic actors in globalization, sometimes with revenues exceeding the GDP of entire nations. A modern product is rarely made in one country: a single smartphone might have chip design in the US, semiconductor fabrication in Taiwan, rare-earth mineral mining in the DRC, and assembly in China or Vietnam — a **global supply chain** in action.

Philippine Example — BPO Industry

The Philippine Business Process Outsourcing (BPO) industry — call centers, back-office processing, IT services — is a direct product of global supply chains extending into SERVICES, not just physical goods, employing over a million Filipinos.

Approach	Core Idea	Tools Used
Free Trade	Minimal government interference in cross-border trade; let comparative advantage determine what each country produces	Trade agreements (FTAs), tariff reduction, open borders for goods/capital
Protectionism	Shield domestic industries from foreign competition to protect local jobs and strategic sectors	Tariffs (import taxes), import quotas, subsidies for domestic producers

Current 2025-2026 Example — Rising Protectionism

Renewed tariff disputes between major economies through 2025-2026, alongside the new 1% US tax specifically targeting outbound remittances, are live examples of protectionist tools being actively deployed right now.

The Fourth Industrial Revolution

Coined by Klaus Schwab, founder of the World Economic Forum, the **Fourth Industrial Revolution (4IR)** describes the current wave of technological change built on top of the digital foundation laid by the Third Industrial Revolution — but going further by blurring the lines between the physical, digital, and biological worlds.

Revolution	Era	Defining Shift
1st	Late 1700s	Steam power, mechanization of production
2nd	Late 1800s–early 1900s	Electricity, mass production, assembly lines
3rd	1960s–2000s	Electronics, computers, the early internet — the "Digital Revolution"
4th	2010s–present	AI, robotics, the Internet of Things, biotechnology, and nanotechnology converging

and merging the physical,
digital, and biological worlds

Why 4IR Is Different, Not Just "More Technology"

- **Velocity** — change is happening at an exponential, not linear, pace
- **Breadth and depth** — entire systems of production, management, and governance are being transformed, not just individual products
- **Systems impact** — it reshapes whole industries, economies, and even raises questions about what it means to be human (as biology and technology increasingly merge)

Opportunities vs. Risks

Opportunities: new industries, major productivity gains, medical breakthroughs, improved quality of life. **Risks:** automation displacing routine jobs, capital owners benefiting far more than labor (widening inequality — connects to Chapter 05), privacy and surveillance concerns, and a constant need for reskilling as job requirements shift faster than before.

Why This Chapter Matters Directly for a BSIT Student

The Philippine BPO industry — the same one cited above as a globalization success story — is also one of the sectors most exposed to 4IR-driven automation, as AI chatbots and voice systems take over routine customer service work. Philippine government digital transformation initiatives are also accelerating. This is the most direct link this entire course has to your actual degree program: the skills you're building in BSIT sit right at the center of this shift.

WEEK 5–6

CHAPTER 03

Facilitators of Globalization & Theories of Globalization

Chapter 02 showed WHAT was built. This chapter asks two different questions: WHAT specific forces made all of that possible (facilitators), and WHAT theoretical frameworks scholars use to explain and critique globalization's actual outcomes — particularly whether it benefits everyone equally.

Facilitators of Globalization

A **facilitator** here means any concrete force, technology, or policy that made deeper global integration physically and practically possible — the "engines" underneath the abstract process.

Facilitator	How It Enables Globalization
Technological infrastructure	The internet, mobile networks, and satellites make instant global communication and data flow possible
Transportation advances	Containerized shipping and commercial aviation made moving goods and people across the world dramatically cheaper and faster
Multinational corporations & FDI	Direct investment spreads production, capital, and jobs across borders (Chapter 02)
International financial institutions & trade agreements	The IMF, World Bank, WTO, and FTAs provide shared rules and infrastructure that make cross-border trade and finance predictable
Global media & communication networks	Spread information, culture, and ideas across borders almost instantly (Chapter 06)
Migration networks & diaspora communities	Move labor, remittances, and cultural practices across borders, and lower the cost of future migration for others (Chapter 07)
English as a global lingua franca	Reduces communication friction for international business, science, and diplomacy

Theories of Globalization

Beyond the process-focused Hyperglobalist / Skeptic / Transformationalist debate from Chapter 01, a separate set of theories tries to explain WHO actually benefits from globalization, and why some countries stay poor while others get rich. Your syllabus explicitly asks you to critique the theories that "lend justification" to globalization — these are the ones most commonly targeted.

Modernization Theory

Development framework

"Traditional" →

"Modern"

Claims developing societies naturally progress toward becoming industrialized, Western-style "modern" societies by adopting the same technology, institutions, and values today's developed nations already have — following the same path.

Dependency Theory

Critical/structural framework

Core exploits Periphery

Argues developing ("periphery") countries stay poor not from a lack of modernization, but because their economies are structurally dependent on, and exploited by, wealthy "core" countries — a legacy of colonialism perpetuated through trade and debt.

World-Systems Theory

Immanuel Wallerstein

Core-Semi-Periphery-Periphery

The global economy is one interconnected system divided into wealthy industrialized "core" countries, transitional "semi-periphery" countries, and resource-exporting "periphery" countries — a nation's position constrains its development options.

Exam-Critical — The Theory Most Often Criticized

Modernization Theory is the theory most frequently targeted for critique in Philippine Contemporary World courses: critics argue it treats the Western development path as the ONLY legitimate one, ignores how colonialism actively created today's inequality (rather than developing countries simply "not catching up" yet), and can function as an ideological justification for continued Western economic influence dressed up as "helping" developing nations modernize. Dependency Theory and World-Systems Theory were both developed largely as direct responses to this critique.

Economic Globalization vs. Economic Nationalism — Where Does the Philippines Stand?

Your syllabus explicitly asks you to defend a stance on whether the Philippines should embrace economic globalization or economic nationalism — a strong candidate for a position paper or recitation prompt.

Case for Economic Globalization	Case for Economic Nationalism
BPO jobs and FDI depend on the Philippines staying open to global business	Reduces vulnerability to sudden foreign policy shocks, like the 2026 US remittance tax
OFW remittances (\$35.6B in 2025) require continued global labor mobility	Protects domestic agriculture and strategic industries from being undercut by cheaper imports
Access to global markets, technology, and investment accelerates growth	Strengthens food security and reduces dependency on volatile global supply chains
Regional integration (ASEAN) offers scale advantages a single small economy can't reach alone	Keeps more decision-making power over the domestic economy inside the country itself

Strongest Answer Pattern

The strongest position papers on this prompt don't pick a pure extreme — they argue for **SELECTIVE** engagement: staying open where the Philippines has a genuine advantage (BPO, labor migration) while protecting specific vulnerable sectors (agriculture, strategic industries) — essentially a managed, not maximal, version of economic globalization.

WEEK 7–8

CHAPTER 04

The Global Interstate System & Global Governance

If there's no single "world government," how does the world organize itself at all, and how does the international community coordinate on shared problems? This chapter covers both the underlying **STATE SYSTEM** the whole world operates within, and the **GOVERNANCE** institutions built on top of it to manage cooperation without erasing state sovereignty.

| The Global Interstate System

The **interstate system** is the foundational structure of modern international relations: a world divided into sovereign, territorially bounded nation-states, each recognized as the supreme legal authority within its own borders. This system traces back to the **Peace of Westphalia (1648)**, which ended a series of European religious wars by establishing that states would not interfere in each other's internal and religious affairs — the origin of the modern concept of sovereignty.

- **Sovereignty** — a state holds supreme authority over its own territory and internal affairs
- **Territoriality** — states have defined, recognized borders
- **Anarchy (in the IR sense)** — there is no central world government ABOVE states, unlike the ordered hierarchy within a single country
- **Self-help** — because there's no central authority to appeal to, states ultimately rely on their own power or alliances for security

Two Basic Lenses for Reading State Behavior

Realism

States act on self-interest and power

Conflict and competition are inherent to an anarchic system; security is every state's primary concern; cooperation is possible but always fragile and secondary to self-interest.

Liberalism / Idealism

Cooperation is achievable and beneficial

International institutions, trade, and shared norms create real interdependence that reduces the likelihood of conflict — the theoretical foundation most global governance institutions are built on.

Related concept: **balance of power** — states and alliances counterbalance each other's strength specifically to prevent any single state from dominating the whole system.

| What Is Global Governance?

Global governance refers to the collective ways states, international organizations, and other actors cooperate to manage shared global problems — WITHOUT a central world government holding binding authority over sovereign nations. It relies on treaties, voluntary cooperation, shared norms, and institutions that countries choose to join and can, in principle, choose to leave. In other words: governance is the layer of cooperation states have built ON TOP OF the anarchic interstate system described above, precisely because some problems (pandemics, climate change, trade) can't be solved by any single state alone.

| The United Nations System

193

UN Member States (nearly every country on Earth)

1945

Founded, after WWII, headquartered in New York

6

Official UN languages

Main UN Bodies

Body	Function
General Assembly	All 193 member states, one vote each — the main deliberative body, votes on resolutions (mostly non-binding recommendations)
Security Council	15 members (5 permanent: US, UK, France, Russia, China + 10 rotating). Only body that can authorize binding, enforceable action, including military intervention. The 5 permanent members hold VETO power — any

Body	Function
	one can block a resolution regardless of how the other 14 vote.
Secretariat	Administrative arm, headed by the Secretary-General, carries out the day-to-day work and programs of the UN
International Court of Justice (ICJ)	Settles legal disputes BETWEEN states (not individuals), based in The Hague, Netherlands
ECOSOC	Economic and Social Council — coordinates UN economic, social, and related agency work (WHO, UNESCO, UNICEF report here)

The Veto Power Problem — Frequently Tested

The Security Council veto means the UN's most powerful enforcement body can be paralyzed whenever a conflict involves the interests of any ONE of the 5 permanent members. This structural flaw is a standard essay topic: "Is the UN Security Council structure still fit for purpose in today's world?" — there is no single correct answer, but you should be able to explain BOTH the original post-WWII logic for the veto and its modern criticisms.

State Sovereignty vs Global Governance — The Central Tension

Current, Highly Citable 2026 Example

In January 2026, the United States formally withdrew from more than 60 international organizations and declared open opposition to the UN's Sustainable Development Goals and the 2030 Agenda. In 2025, the US voted with the international majority on only about 5% of UN General Assembly resolutions where a vote was recorded — a dramatic outlier. This is a live, real-time demonstration of the sovereignty-vs-global-governance tension described above: a powerful state choosing its own sovereignty and interests over collective multilateral commitments.

Other Major International Organizations

Organization	Focus
WHO — World Health Organization	Global public health coordination, disease outbreak response (covered in depth in Chapter 08)
UNESCO	Education, science, and cultural cooperation; maintains the World Heritage Site list
UNICEF	Children's welfare, education, and protection worldwide
NATO	Military alliance (mostly North America + Europe), collective defense pact
ASEAN	Southeast Asian regional political and economic cooperation (covered in depth in Chapter 05)

International Law — How Does It Actually Get Enforced?

Unlike domestic law, international law has no single police force or automatic enforcement mechanism. It relies primarily on: (1) states voluntarily complying to maintain their reputation and relationships, (2) economic sanctions imposed by other states as a consequence for violations, (3) the ICJ and International Criminal Court (ICC) issuing rulings — though these bodies still depend on state cooperation to actually enforce judgments, since neither has its own police force.

MIDTERM EXAMINATION — WEEK 9

Covers Chapters 01–04. Everything above this marker is midterm-scope material.

North-South Divide, Global Inequality, Latin America & ASEAN

This chapter opens the final-term stretch by asking the central fairness question of the whole course: has globalization narrowed the gap between rich and poor countries, or widened it? It examines the world's most common regional framing for that gap, plus two regional case studies — Latin America and ASEAN — that illustrate opposite ends of the development spectrum.

The North-South Divide

The **Global North** and **Global South** are informal socio-economic groupings, not strict geography — the terms describe wealthier, more industrialized nations (roughly North America, Europe, and developed parts of East Asia and Oceania) versus poorer, developing nations (roughly most of Africa, Latin America, and Asia). The dividing line is commonly traced back to the **Brandt Line**, a rough boundary drawn near 30°N latitude in the 1980 Brandt Report led by former West German Chancellor Willy Brandt.

Known Limitation of the Framework

The North-South split oversimplifies real diversity within each group — wealthy Gulf states technically sit in the geographic "South," while poorer regions exist inside "Northern" countries too. The rise of large emerging Southern economies (China, India, Brazil) has blurred the line further, which is itself a common critique/essay angle.

Two Kinds of Global Inequality

Type	Definition	Trend
Inequality BETWEEN countries	Gaps in average wealth/income comparing entire nations against each other	Has generally NARROWED in recent decades — largely due to rapid growth in China, India, and other emerging economies

Type	Definition	Trend
Inequality WITHIN countries	Gaps between rich and poor citizens inside the same nation	Has WIDENED in many countries, including highly globalized economies, where gains from trade and technology often concentrate among already-wealthy groups

The Key Insight Professors Look For

A country can look more "globally equal" on average (between-country gap narrowing) while its OWN citizens experience worsening inequality (within-country gap widening) at the same time. Both things are simultaneously true — this apparent contradiction is a favorite exam and discussion topic precisely because it resists a simple answer.

Regional Case Study — Latin America

Latin America is a frequently cited example of how colonial history shapes long-term economic structure — a direct parallel to the Philippines' own Spanish colonial past (Chapter 02).

- **Colonial legacy:** Spanish and Portuguese colonization established extractive, raw-material-export economies that shaped regional development patterns still visible today
- **The 1980s debt crisis ("Lost Decade"):** Multiple Latin American countries defaulted on foreign debt, leading to IMF-imposed structural adjustment programs — a real-world illustration of Dependency Theory (Chapter 03) in action
- **Regional integration — Mercosur:** the Southern Common Market (Argentina, Brazil, Paraguay, Uruguay, and associates), Latin America's rough equivalent of ASEAN or the EU
- **Current relevance:** continued reliance on commodity exports and recurring political/economic volatility, alongside a growing voice within broader "Global South" solidarity movements

Regional Case Study — ASEAN

1967

Founded (Bangkok Declaration)

10

Member states, incl. the Philippines

2015

ASEAN Economic Community (AEC) established

ASEAN began with five founding members — Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore, and Thailand — and later grew to ten with the addition of Brunei, Vietnam, Laos, Myanmar, and Cambodia. The **ASEAN Economic Community (AEC)** aims for the freer movement of goods, services, investment, capital, and skilled labor within the region — ASEAN's answer to the EU's single market, though considerably less integrated (no shared currency, weaker enforcement mechanisms).

ASEAN as a Microcosm of the North-South Divide

ASEAN's own members span a wide development range internally — Singapore functions almost like a "Northern," highly developed economy, while Myanmar, Cambodia, and Laos remain much less developed. This makes ASEAN a useful smaller-scale illustration of the exact same North-South tension playing out globally, just compressed into one region.

The Philippines has been an ASEAN member since its founding, remains active in regional geopolitics (including the South China Sea / West Philippine Sea disputes), and participates heavily in intra-ASEAN labor migration.

WEEK 12–13

CHAPTER 06

Media Platforms and Globalization

Beyond money and governments, globalization moves IDEAS, VALUES, and CULTURAL PRODUCTS across borders at unprecedented speed — reshaping

the political, economic, and social landscape of the "new world order" your syllabus specifically asks about, and reshaping how people everywhere eat, dress, communicate, and see themselves in the process.

| Cultural Globalization — Two Competing Fears

Concept	Core Argument
Cultural Homogenization	Global media and consumer brands are erasing local cultural differences, producing an increasingly uniform global culture — critics call this "Americanization" or "Westernization" of global taste, values, and consumption habits.
Cultural Hybridization	Local cultures don't passively absorb global influences — they actively blend, remix, and reinterpret them, producing entirely new hybrid cultural forms rather than simple uniformity.

| Glocalization

Coined by sociologist Roland Robertson (Ch. 01), **glocalization** describes how global products and ideas get actively ADAPTED to local contexts rather than simply imposed unchanged. This is the most widely cited concept for explaining what actually happens in cultural globalization, more so than pure homogenization.

Philippine Examples of Glocalization

McDonald's serving **McSpaghetti** and rice meals only in the Philippines. Jollibee — a genuinely Filipino brand — expanding internationally while keeping Filipino flavor profiles for diaspora communities abroad. K-pop and Spotify algorithms surfacing OPM (Original Pilipino Music) to global audiences. Each is neither purely "global" nor purely "local" — they're a deliberate blend.

Media Platforms & Global Communication Order

Each era's dominant media technology directly reshaped who could participate in global communication, and how much control governments and broadcasters held over that flow.

Era	Dominant Media Platform	Characteristic
Pre-1990s	Print, radio, broadcast TV	Largely one-directional (national broadcasters to national audiences), limited cross-border flow, tightly controlled by governments/networks
1990s-2000s	Cable TV, early internet	24-hour global news networks (CNN), beginning of real-time cross-border information flow
2010s-present	Social media, streaming platforms	Instant, many-to-many global communication; ordinary individuals, not just broadcasters, now shape global cultural, economic, and political flows (viral trends, influencer culture, crowdfunded movements)

Political, Economic & Social Landscape Effects

Political: social media enables rapid mobilization and disinformation alike, reshaping elections and protest movements worldwide. **Economic:** e-commerce and digital platforms let even small Philippine sellers reach global buyers directly. **Social:** algorithmic media exposes people to global trends and communities faster than traditional gatekeepers ever could, for better and worse.

| Digital Culture & the Filipino Internet Presence

The Philippines is consistently ranked among the world's heaviest social media-using populations by time spent online. This creates a genuinely two-way cultural flow: Filipino content, memes, and trends increasingly influence global online culture, not just the reverse — a meaningful shift from earlier eras where cultural flow was overwhelmingly one-directional (developed world to developing world).

| Language & Globalization

Trend	Detail
English as global lingua franca	Dominant language of international business, science, aviation, and the internet — a direct legacy of British and American global influence historically
Language endangerment	UNESCO estimates a significant share of the world's roughly 7,000 languages are at risk of disappearing this century, partly due to globalization pressure favoring dominant languages
Digital code-switching •	Taglish (Tagalog-English mixing) itself is an everyday linguistic product of globalization — reflecting the Philippines' colonial history and ongoing global integration simultaneously

Common Reflection Essay Prompt

"Is globalization erasing Filipino culture, or strengthening it?" Strong answers avoid a simple yes/no — they apply glocalization directly: Filipino culture is simultaneously **ABSORBING** global influences (K-pop, US media, global fast food) **AND** actively **EXPORTING** itself globally (OFW diaspora spreading Filipino food/language worldwide, OPM gaining international streaming traction). Both directions are happening at once.

Global Population & Mobility, Demographic Transition, Migration & Urbanization

People move — for work, safety, education, and family. This chapter covers global migration patterns, the demographic transition model, and urbanization, with special attention to the Philippines' unique, massive role in global labor migration, since this is very likely to appear as a case-study essay question or feed the "My Kind of City" group activity.

Current Global Population Snapshot

8.3B

Current world population (2026)

1.5B

India — most populous country

1.4B

China — 2nd most populous, now declining

31.1

Global median age (years)

The UN projects global population will peak around **10.3 billion in the mid-2080s** before gradually declining — driven mainly by falling fertility rates worldwide, now averaging 2.3 births per woman globally (down from far higher rates a generation ago).

The Demographic Transition Model

The **demographic transition model (DTM)** describes how a country's birth rate and death rate typically change as it develops economically — and therefore how fast (or slow) its population grows at each stage.

Stage	Birth Rate	Death Rate	Population Growth	Typical Example
1 — High Stationary	High	High	Low/stable	Pre-industrial societies (rare today)
2 — Early Expanding	Stays high	Falls sharply (better healthcare, sanitation, food)	Rapid growth	Least-developed countries, parts of Sub-Saharan Africa
3 — Late Expanding	Begins falling (urbanization, education, family planning access)	Continues falling slowly	Growth slows	Many developing countries, including much of the Philippines' current profile
4 — Low Stationary	Low	Low	Stable, slow growth	Most developed countries (US, much of Europe)
5 — Decline (sometimes added)	Falls below death rate	Low, but births are lower still	Population shrinks and ages	Japan, South Korea, increasingly China

Don't Overstate the Philippines' Exact Stage

The Philippines is generally described as being in late Stage 2 to Stage 3 — death rates are low, but birth rates, while declining, remain moderately elevated relative to fully developed Stage 4 countries. Treat this as a general

positioning, not an exact classification, and confirm the specific framing your professor uses in the actual lecture.

Types of Human Migration

Type	Definition	Example
Labor migration	Moving primarily to work	OFWs, guest worker programs
Forced migration / refugees	Fleeing conflict, persecution, or disaster	Refugees from war zones, climate disasters
Internal migration	Moving within one's own country	Rural-to-urban migration to Metro Manila
Circular / temporary migration	Moving abroad for a fixed period, then returning	OFW contract workers on 2-year deployments
Permanent migration / diaspora settlement	Relocating and settling long-term or permanently abroad	Filipino-American, Filipino-Canadian communities

The Philippines: A Global Labor Migration Case Study

2.19M

Overseas Filipino Workers, 2024 (PSA)

\$35.6B

Total cash remittances, 2025 — an all-time record

7.3%

Share of Philippine GDP from remittances alone

57%

Share of OFWs who are women

The Philippines is consistently the **world's 4th-largest remittance recipient**, after India, Mexico, and China — and the world's largest single source of seafarers and among the top sources of nurses globally.

Current 2026 Development Worth Knowing

A new 1% US tax on outbound cash remittances took effect in 2026, specifically affecting money OFWs in America send home. Economists tracked a surge in remittances in December 2025 as OFWs rushed to transfer funds before the tax began — a real, current illustration of how a single policy change in one country can immediately ripple into millions of Filipino households.

Why Migration Matters — Weighing Both Sides

Benefits of Labor Migration	Costs of Labor Migration
Remittances significantly boost household income and national GDP	"Brain drain" — countries lose skilled workers (nurses, engineers) they invested in educating
Workers gain skills, savings, and international experience	Family separation — millions of Filipino children grow up with one or both parents working abroad
Relieves domestic unemployment pressure	Vulnerability to exploitation, unsafe working conditions, or unfair labor practices abroad
Builds diaspora networks that support trade, tourism, and cultural exchange	Economic dependency on remittances can discourage domestic job creation

Urbanization & Global Cities

More than half the world's population now lives in urban areas, a trend accelerating rapidly in developing countries. **Global cities** — like New York, London, Tokyo, Singapore, and increasingly Manila — function as command centers for the global economy: hubs for finance, corporate headquarters, media, and international migration, disproportionately influential relative to their physical size.

Metro Manila as a Global City

Metro Manila (including Quezon City, where QCU sits) functions as the Philippines' primary global city node — hosting the BPO industry's headquarters, major international corporate offices, embassies, and serving as the departure/return point for the majority of the country's 2+ million OFWs. Good raw material if the "My Kind of City" activity asks you to design or evaluate an ideal globalized, sustainable city.

WEEK 16–17

CHAPTER 08

Globalization Amid the Deadly Pandemic — COVID-19

COVID-19 is the clearest real-world stress test globalization has faced this century. This chapter covers how the pandemic exposed globalization's fragility, and how different countries' responses can inform better preventive policy — directly feeding your required Reflection Paper for this unit.

How COVID-19 Exposed Globalization's Fragility

Disruption	What Happened
Supply chain breakdown	Global supply chains broke down nearly simultaneously worldwide; single-source dependency on specific countries for goods like PPE and semiconductors caused severe shortages, prompting many firms to pursue "reshoring" or "friend-shoring" afterward
Border closures & travel bans	Nearly universal, sudden halt of international travel and migration proved that even a supposedly "borderless" world can snap back to hard national borders within days — real-time support for the Skeptic/Realist view that state sovereignty remains powerful

Disruption	What Happened
Vaccine nationalism vs. vaccine diplomacy	Wealthy countries pre-purchased and stockpiled vaccine supply ("vaccine nationalism"), while COVAX — a WHO-led global vaccine-sharing initiative — tried to ensure more equitable distribution but fell short of its targets
WHO's role & criticism	Coordinated global health information and response, but faced real criticism over the speed and independence of its early actions — a live case study for Chapter 04's debate on whether global governance can actually solve global problems
Digital acceleration	Remote work, e-commerce, telemedicine, and online education expanded massively — a form of DIGITAL globalization that deepened even while physical, travel-based globalization froze almost completely

Formulating Preventive Policy — Comparing Country Responses

Your syllabus specifically asks you to formulate preventive policies based on successful approaches used elsewhere. A few comparative patterns worth knowing:

- **Early, aggressive testing and contact tracing** — countries like South Korea and Vietnam that acted early with mass testing and tracing generally slowed initial spread more effectively than countries that waited
- **Strong universal healthcare and public health infrastructure** — countries with more robust existing health systems generally handled surges with fewer excess deaths
- **Coordinated, clearly communicated public messaging** — inconsistent or delayed communication in several countries correlated with lower public compliance and slower containment

The Philippine COVID-19 Experience

The Philippines implemented some of the world's longest lockdowns, which limited early spread but came with major economic contraction, disrupted education (a direct precursor to the "Online Delivery of Instruction" now used in your own courses), and a comparatively slower initial vaccine rollout pace than several neighboring ASEAN countries. This gives you specific, personal-experience material for the required reflection paper.

Reflection Paper Prep — Questions to Actually Answer

Strong reflection papers on this topic engage directly with: (1) how the pandemic personally or locally affected you and your community, (2) what specifically worked or failed in the Philippine response compared to other countries covered above, and (3) what a better-prepared Philippines or world would concretely look like heading into a future pandemic. Generic "COVID was hard for everyone" reflections score lower than ones grounded in specific comparisons like the table above.

FINAL EXAMINATION — WEEK 18

Covers Chapters 05–08 (final-term scope), though comprehensive finals may draw on the whole course.

ENRICHMENT — NOT ON OFFICIAL OBTL

CHAPTER 09

Environment, Sustainability & Global Citizenship — Supplementary

This chapter does not correspond to a specific week on your official syllabus. It's kept here as general GE enrichment, since environment/sustainability and global-citizenship themes are common in other sections of this course and can still surface in a comprehensive final essay tying the whole semester together. Treat everything below as lower priority than Chapters 00–08 unless your professor explicitly assigns it.

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

Adopted by all 193 UN member states in 2015 as the **2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development** — 17 interconnected goals covering poverty, health, education, equality, climate, and governance, meant to be achieved by 2030.

1 No Poverty

2 Zero Hunger

3 Good Health & Well-being

4 Quality Education

5 Gender Equality

6 Clean Water & Sanitation

7 Affordable Clean Energy

8 Decent Work & Growth

9 Industry, Innovation, Infrastructure

10 Reduced Inequalities

11 Sustainable Cities

12 Responsible Consumption

13 Climate Action

14 Life Below Water

15 Life on Land

16 Peace, Justice, Strong Institutions

17 Partnerships for the Goals

Current 2026 Status — Genuinely Off Track

As of the 2026 Sustainable Development Report, **none of the 17 SDGs are on track to be achieved by the 2030 deadline**. Roughly 16% of specific targets are progressing well, while another 16% are actively worsening. SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities), 14 (Life Below Water), 15 (Life on Land), and 16 (Peace, Justice, Institutions) are flagged as particularly off-track globally.

Climate Change as a Global Governance Problem

Climate change is the textbook example of a **collective action problem**: every country benefits from a stable climate, but any single country reducing emissions alone bears real economic costs while other countries "free-ride" on the benefit.

Agreement	Year	Key Feature
Kyoto Protocol	1997	First binding emissions targets, but only for developed countries — the US never ratified it
Paris Agreement	2015	Nearly universal participation; each country sets its OWN voluntary emissions targets ("Nationally Determined Contributions") rather than binding external targets

| The Philippines & Climate Vulnerability

The Philippines is consistently ranked among the world's most disaster-vulnerable countries — facing an average of 20+ tropical cyclones annually, alongside earthquakes, volcanic activity, and rising sea levels. This makes the Philippines a frequently cited example of **climate injustice**: the country contributes a very small share of global greenhouse gas emissions historically, yet bears disproportionately severe consequences.

| Global Citizenship

Global citizenship is the idea that, beyond national identity, individuals hold responsibilities toward the wider world — human rights, environmental stewardship, and solidarity with people in other countries — even without any formal global government to enforce these obligations.

| Synthesis — The Philippines Across Every Chapter

Chapter	Philippine Connection
01 — Globalization & Metaphors	OFW example touches all five dimensions simultaneously
02 — Structure, Economy & 4IR	BPO industry as both a globalization success story and a 4IR automation risk
03 — Facilitators & Theories	Live economic-globalization-vs-nationalism debate around the 2026 remittance tax
04 — Interstate System & Governance	UN member state; navigates sovereignty tensions amid great-power competition in the region
05 — North-South, Inequality & ASEAN	Founding ASEAN member; internal North-South-style development gaps within the bloc
06 — Media & Globalization	Jollibee, McSpaghetti, OPM — textbook globalization case studies
07 — Population, Migration & Cities	World's 4th-largest remittance recipient; massive labor migration economy

The Question This Whole Course Builds Toward

Nearly every final exam or capstone essay in this course asks some version of: *"Is globalization good or bad for the Philippines?"* The strongest answers reject the binary. Globalization has brought the Philippines real economic lifelines (remittances, BPO jobs) while also exposing it to real vulnerabilities (climate injustice, dependency on volatile foreign policy decisions, brain drain, pandemic shocks). A synthesis answer — weighing BOTH the benefits and the costs with specific, current evidence from this guide — will consistently outperform a one-sided answer.

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